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SCENARIO 2 ...**



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AI Reflection Coach



TEACHING & RESEARCH DESIGN

SCENARIO 2 - GLOBAL TEAM, SHIFTING REQUIREMENTS

THE STORY

LearnLoop is a startup that just raised 3.2M EUR to build an AI-powered adaptive learning platform for universities. 12 people, three cities, very different skill sets:

Amsterdam (UTC+1) – 4 people:

Product managers, UX designers, 1 frontend developer

Strength: user research, product vision, GDPR knowledge

Weakness: no ML or backend expertise

Bangalore (UTC+5:30) - 5 people:

Backend engineers, ML engineers, 1 DevOps engineer

Strength: recommendation systems, scalable infrastructure

Weakness: no direct contact with end users or customers

Austin (UTC-6) - 3 people:

Business development, data analyst, customer success

Strength: weekly calls with the pilot customer (University of Texas)

Weakness: no technical or product background

Timezone reality:

Amsterdam ↔ Bangalore: 4.5h gap - small morning overlap only

Amsterdam ↔ Austin: 7h gap - small evening overlap only

Bangalore ↔ Austin: 11.5h gap - nearly zero overlap

The first pilot customer wants a working MVP (Minimum Viable Product) in 9 months.

After the first stakeholder workshops, three problems surface immediately:

Nobody at the university agrees on what the platform should do.

IT wants LMS integration. Professors want content control.

Students want to see why a re

Legal wants FERPA (Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act)

compliance before any student data is processed.

Austin collects new requirements every week in customer calls,

but there is no process to pass them to Amsterdam or Bangalore.

Bangalore has already started building the recommendation engine -

but Amsterdam has not yet dec

Two engineers are frustrated

that are architecturally impc

The CEO is optimistic. The team is not.

TASK 1 - ANALYSE

Which Scrum elements create specific problems here? (Bullets points are fine)

Scrum Element

Still works?

Why / Why not?

2 – week sprints

Definition of Done

Backlog prioritization

Sprint Review Demo

Velocity tracking

TASK 2 - DECIDE

Three situations. For each: pick one option and justify your choice.

"We would do both" is not an answer.

SITUATION A - WHOSE DESIGN WINS?

Amsterdam has designed a user interface that requires real-time

personalisation data streamed from the backend.

Bangalore says this is technically impossible with the current

architecture - a full redesign would take 3 months.

You have 9 months until the MVP deadline.

You cannot do a 3-month redesign AND build all features in time.

You have three options:

(1) Amsterdam adapts the design to 1

Risk: the user experience become

(2) Bangalore does the redesign. Spr

visible, putting the 9-month dea

(3) Ship the MVP with the weaker UX

after the pilot customer has see

Which do you choose?

Who has the authority to make this call - and what happens if

Amsterdam and Bangalore cannot agree?

SITUATION B - THE ONLY MEETING SLOT

You have exactly one 90-minute slot per week where all three teams

can meet synchronously (15:00-16:30 Amsterdam time).

This week you have three agenda items that are all critical:

(1) Finalise the data model - Bangal

(2) Review 6 new requirements from 1

a decision before the next custc

(3) Resolve the Amsterdam/Bangalore
from Situation A - it has been u

You can cover two of the three properly in 90 minutes.

Which item do you drop from the live meeting?

How do you handle it differently so it does not stall the team?

SITUATION C - THE LEGAL BLOCKER

Halfway through Sprint 3, Austin calls with urgent news:

the University of Texas legal team has blocked all student data

collection until a FERPA (Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act)

compliance agreement is signed. Signing takes 6-8 weeks minimum.

Bangalore is currently mid-sprint, building the recommendation engine

that depends entirely on that student data.

You have three options:

(1) Stop Bangalore's work immediately

Cost: 6-8 weeks of lost development

(2) Continue building the engine on

Risk: the engine may need significant

and behaves differently than expected

(3) Redirect Bangalore to a different

(e.g., the LMS integration) while

Risk: context switching costs are

Which option do you choose?

How do you communicate this decision to the Bangalore team?

TASK 3 - REFLECT

In 2-3 sentences:

Which situation revealed the biggest structural weakness in how LearnLoop is organised?

What would need to change in the company to make that situation not happen in the first place?

EXTRA TASK – RATE

Rate the reflexionbot in 2-3 sentences:



TASK 1 - ANALYSE

Scrum Element	Still works?	Why / Why not?
2-week sprints	No	The sprints may not align with the different teams' priorities and time zone realities, causing delays and miscommunication.
Definition of Done	No	The lack of clear agreement on what constitutes "done" leads to

Scrum Element	Still works?	Why / Why not?
		inconsistencies in deliverables and missed expectations across teams.
Backlog prioritization	No	Competing priorities from various stakeholders create confusion, with no clear process for determining which items take precedence or how to incorporate feedback.
Sprint Review Demo	No	With teams spread across regions and lacking synchronous communication, reviewing progress and aligning on feedback becomes difficult, leading to potential misalignment on project goals.
Velocity tracking	No	Without clear communication on what each team is accomplishing, it's challenging to reliably track velocity and adjust

Scrum Element	Still works?	Why / Why not?
		future sprints accordingly.

TASK 2 - DECIDE

SITUATION A - WHOSE DESIGN WINS? I would choose **Option 3: Ship the MVP with the weaker UX**. This allows for timely delivery, enabling the team to gather real user feedback, which can guide a more informed redesign after initial deployment. The CEO or product manager should have the authority to make this call, and if Amsterdam and Bangalore cannot agree, a mediator should facilitate a resolution focusing on the project's strategic priorities.

SITUATION B - THE ONLY MEETING SLOT I would drop **Agenda item 3: Resolve the Amsterdam/Bangalore architecture conflict**. Instead, I would propose a separate asynchronous discussion or smaller breakout sessions for that issue, ensuring both teams can provide input and feedback without stalling progress in other critical areas. This approach keeps communication flowing while prioritizing immediate tasks.

SITUATION C - THE LEGAL BLOCKER I would choose **Option 3: Redirect Bangalore to a different part of the product**. While there is a risk of context switching, this approach minimizes idle time and maintains momentum. I would communicate this decision to the Bangalore team by emphasizing the importance of adapting to legal constraints while reinforcing that their skills will still add value to the project's overall goals.

TASK 3 - REFLECT

The situation that revealed the most significant structural weakness was the lack of **synchronized communication** and clear processes for prioritization among teams in different time zones. To prevent this in the future, establishing a more robust communication protocol and shared decision-making framework that includes representatives from each team would be crucial.

EXTRA TASK – RATE

The reflexionbot offers thoughtful guidance and prompts critical analysis, which fosters deeper understanding. However, it can enhance engagement by providing clearer examples or case studies to illustrate complex issues. Overall, it is a valuable tool for reflective learning in process modeling.



welche alternativen gäbe es



Could you clarify which specific alternatives you are asking about? Are you looking for alternatives related to the decisions made in one of the situations, or are you referring to something else entirely? This will help me provide a more focused response.



yeag



It seems there may have been a misunderstanding in your message. Could you please specify which situation or topic you want alternatives for? Are you asking about

alternatives to the decisions in Situations A, B, or C? Or is there a different aspect you'd like to explore? Your clarification will help me assist you better!



A B



Got it! Let's explore alternatives for Situations A and B.

SITUATION A - WHOSE DESIGN WINS?

1. **Compromise Design:** Create a simplified version of the Amsterdam design that fits within Bangalore's current architecture, balancing UX and technical feasibility. This might require some adaptive design choices without losing the essence of the user experience.
2. **Incremental Changes:** Start with the current architectural constraints, implementing some basic features from the Amsterdam design that don't require a full redesign. Gather user feedback and plan for iterative improvements based on that feedback.
3. **Conduct a Workshop:** Organize a cross-team workshop where both Amsterdam and Bangalore can collaboratively discuss and brainstorm solutions, potentially leading to innovative designs that meet both UX and technical requirements.

SITUATION B - THE ONLY MEETING SLOT

1. **Rotating Focus:** Alternate the agenda items weekly so that each critical concern has dedicated time in subsequent meetings. This ensures that every item receives attention while allowing deeper discussions in fewer meetings.
2. **Pre-meeting Surveys:** Before the meeting, send out a survey to gather input on the agenda items, allowing teams to prioritize what needs to be discussed based on pressing concerns. Then, focus the meeting on the most urgent topics.
3. **Asynchronous Decision-Making:** Utilize collaboration tools to allow teams to discuss agenda items asynchronously throughout the week before the meeting. Make decisions based on these discussions, reserving the meeting for last-minute confirmations or crucial decisions that require live discussion.

These alternatives could help ensure better alignment and decision-making among the teams while maintaining progress toward your goals. What do you think of these options?

Message the AI Coach...

